

BootHop

gener8tor Soft Landing Pad -- Wisconsin, USA

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APPLICANT DETAILS

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Company: BootHop
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Co-Founders: Omobolarinwa Famutimi, Dotun Asekun
Team Size: 3 - 5
Stage: Pre-Seed (Bootstrapped, live & generating revenue)
Industries: Commerce and Shopping | Transportation | Financial Services

Keywords:

Marketplace

Peer-to-Peer

Logistics

Last Mile Delivery

Sharing Economy

Gig Economy

Crowdsourcing

Freight Service

Payments

Escrow

Identity Verification

Travel

E-Commerce

FinTech

Mobile

APPLICATION QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Company Description

BootHop is a peer-to-peer delivery marketplace that connects people who need to send goods ("Hoopers") with travelers already heading to the same destination ("Booters"). Instead of paying expensive courier rates, senders pay a fraction of the cost -- and travelers earn extra income from a trip they were already making. BootHop acts as the trusted middleman: verifying identities, holding funds in escrow, and only releasing payment and contact details once both parties are verified and the delivery is confirmed.

Business Model

BootHop operates a transaction-fee marketplace model, taking a cut from every successful delivery completed on the platform. When a sender (Hooper) and traveler (Booter) agree on a delivery price, BootHop charges the sender a 3% platform fee on top of the agreed amount, and retains 5% from the traveler's payout -- meaning the platform earns from both sides of every transaction without holding inventory or owning vehicles. On top of the core transaction fee, we offer optional goods insurance at 10% of the declared item value, giving senders peace of mind and adding a meaningful revenue line on higher-value deliveries. All funds are held in escrow by BootHop until delivery is confirmed by both parties, which protects users and gives the platform full visibility and control over every transaction. We also operate a separate Business Portal, where companies can post commercial delivery jobs and assign vetted carriers -- opening a B2B revenue stream alongside the peer-to-peer consumer model. As transaction volume scales, the dual-sided fee structure compounds quickly: a £100 agreed price generates £8 in platform revenue before insurance. Our model is asset-light, globally portable, and requires no courier fleet -- the more people travel, the more capacity we have.

Competitors

BoothHop operates in a space with several layers of competition. The most direct competitors are peer-to-peer delivery platforms such as Grabr, Nimber, and Piggybee, which also connect travelers with senders -- however, these platforms lack BoothHop's structured trust infrastructure: our escrow model, in-platform KYC identity verification, message filtering, and admin-controlled payment release set us meaningfully apart. Traditional courier and logistics companies -- DHL, FedEx, UPS, Royal Mail, and Parcelforce -- represent the incumbent competition; they are expensive, slow for cross-border personal deliveries, and entirely inaccessible for the informal and diaspora economy we serve. Our largest real-world competitor is the informal status quo: WhatsApp groups, Facebook community pages, and word-of-mouth arrangements where diaspora communities ask friends or strangers to carry items -- this is unregulated, uninsured, and unsafe, but extremely common. Uber Connect competes at the same-city level, but does not address intercity or international routes. What differentiates BoothHop is that we are the only platform combining anonymous intent matching, verified identity, escrowed payments, and controlled contact reveal in a single flow -- meaning neither party is exposed until trust is fully established. We are building the infrastructure layer that turns informal behaviour into a safe, regulated, and scalable marketplace.

Team

BoothHop is led by three co-founders with a combined 70+ years of industry experience across technology, logistics, procurement, and finance -- backgrounds that map directly onto every layer of what BoothHop needs to succeed. Oluwatoyin Olufeko (CEO) brings 27 years of hands-on experience in system development, banking, and supply chain, having built and delivered complex platforms across multiple sectors for UBS, JPMorgan Chase, DHL Aviation, and Walgreens Boots Alliance; he architected and built the BoothHop platform end-to-end. Omobolarinwa Famutimi brings over 20 years in procurement and supply chain operations, giving the team deep commercial insight into how goods move, how supplier relationships are structured, and what enterprises need from a logistics partner -- critical for the B2B side of BoothHop's business portal. Dotun Asekun brings 20+ years specialising in system testing and customs systems, an unusually rare skill set for a startup at this stage -- his expertise means BoothHop is built with compliance, cross-border customs logic, and quality assurance embedded from day one rather than bolted on later. Together the team covers product, operations, and compliance without needing to outsource any core function. Full professional backgrounds for all three founders can be viewed at OTB-MIDAS.com.

Traction

BoothHop launched four months ago and is already generating approximately \$500 per month in revenue (USD equivalent) -- a meaningful early signal for a marketplace that requires trust-building on both sides before transactions occur. The platform is fully live at www.boothop.com with real paying users completing end-to-end deliveries through our match, KYC, escrow, and confirmation flow. In four months we have built and deployed a complete two-sided marketplace including identity verification, escrow payments, in-app messaging, dispute resolution, a business portal for commercial clients, and an automated matching engine -- infrastructure that typically takes funded startups 12-18 months to ship. Our focus for the next phase is growing transaction volume and expanding our active user base across UK diaspora corridors and into the US market. All current revenue figures are in USD equivalent.

Biggest Challenges (besides funding)

BootHop's biggest challenges are trust, liquidity, and cross-border compliance. First, building trust on both sides of a two-sided marketplace is hard -- senders must trust a stranger to carry their goods, and travelers must trust the platform to hold and release their money fairly. We are solving this through our layered trust model: KYC identity verification, escrow payments, content-filtered messaging, and admin-controlled fund release. But trust takes time and transaction history to compound. Second, the classic cold-start problem: a marketplace needs supply (travelers) and demand (senders) in the same corridors at the same time. Too few travelers means slow matching; too few senders means travelers don't bother listing. We are addressing this through targeted diaspora community outreach and our automated matching engine, but growing both sides simultaneously in new markets remains our most operationally intensive challenge. Third, cross-border compliance: different markets have different customs laws, prohibited goods lists, and financial regulations. We have built compliance prompts, terms acceptance tracking, and customs guidance into the platform, but scaling this across multiple jurisdictions will require legal partnerships in each market -- particularly for US entry. Finally, changing informal behaviour: our biggest real-world competitor is not another app, it is the WhatsApp group. Convincing diaspora communities to move from informal arrangements to a structured platform requires consistent education and a trust track record we are still building.

Reason for Selection -- Why should we select your team?

BootHop is not a concept -- it is a live, revenue-generating platform built and shipped in under four months by a three-person team with a combined 70 years of experience across enterprise technology, supply chain, procurement, and cross-border compliance. We are solving a real, underserved problem in a market we know intimately: the diaspora delivery corridor between the UK, Nigeria, and now the United States, where millions of people currently rely on unregulated WhatsApp arrangements with no identity verification, no escrow, and no legal protection. Our team brings exactly what a Soft Landing Pad programme needs -- a technical founder who has delivered mission-critical systems for UBS, JPMorgan Chase, and DHL Aviation, an operations lead with 20 years of procurement networks across the UK and West Africa, and a compliance lead with 20 years in customs and system testing who ensures we build right, not just fast. We are not coming to Wisconsin to figure out our idea -- we are coming to execute a US market entry strategy with a working product, paying customers, and the operational discipline to grow. gener8tor's network and mentorship would give us the relationships and local credibility to do in months what would otherwise take us years to build from scratch.